

MORNING BRIEFING — THURSDAY 13 AUGUST 2026

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2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Houthi attack kills six on Red Sea cargo ship; US forces fire on vessel near Gulf of Oman blockade — Hormuz effectively shut to normal traffic

[Al Jazeera](#) / [CNBC](#) • Wed 12 Aug

Iran-backed Houthi rebels killed six people in an attack on a cargo ship in the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, the first Red Sea shipping fatalities in over a year. Separately, US forces said they fired on a container ship allegedly trying to breach the US blockade of Iranian ports in the Gulf of Oman. The Strait of Hormuz is effectively closed to normal commercial shipping, with naval-escorted convoys the only traffic (roughly 8 ships/day transiting versus ~73/day normal). Tanker charter rates have surged roughly 20-fold on some routes toward \$500,000/day and war-risk insurance has jumped to 3-10% of hull value from ~0.25% pre-war. This is the dominant cross-asset driver for oil, shipping and aviation names today.

US July CPI cools to 3.4% y/y but September Fed hike odds stay elevated under new Chair Warsh

[BLS](#) / [Bloomberg](#) / [Forbes](#) • Wed 12 Aug

Headline CPI eased to 3.4% y/y (core 2.5%, down from 2.6%), matching expectations. Unusually, this remains a hiking-bias cycle, not a cutting one: the FOMC under new Chair Kevin Warsh voted 9-3 to hold at 3.50-3.75% in July, with three dissents favouring a hike. Market-implied odds of a September hike sit roughly 40-50% post-CPI (source estimates vary, down from as high as 67% a week earlier). This unusual hike-risk regime is a key driver for European rates and EUR/USD today.

Cisco beats and raises but stock sells off after-hours, pressuring Nasdaq futures

[Cisco investor relations](#) / [Investing.com](#) • after Wed 12 Aug US close

Cisco's fiscal Q4 results topped estimates (EPS \$1.22 vs \$1.17 est., revenue \$17.3bn vs \$16.82bn est.) and management raised AI order-backlog language to roughly \$9bn, yet shares sold off in after-hours trading — a "beat-and-raise, sell the news" reaction. Nasdaq 100 e-mini futures were reported slipping around 0.1% in early Asian trade. Relevant read-through for European tech and networking names at today's open.

Korean chip stocks surge on reports Temasek plans direct stakes in Samsung and SK Hynix

[Bloomberg](#) / [AP](#) / [Korea JoongAng Daily](#) • overnight Wed 12 – Thu 13 Aug

South Korea's Kospi jumped roughly 3.9-4.8% (source estimates vary) to around 6,835 after reports that Singapore's Temasek Holdings plans to directly invest in Samsung Electronics (+~5%) and SK Hynix (+~7-8%). This extends the AI/memory-chip rally that followed strong US AI earnings and is a significant overnight read-through for European chip-equipment names (ASML, ASM International, BESI) at today's open.

Wall Street finishes just shy of a record on tame CPI and AI-earnings strength

[AP wire](#) • Wed 12 Aug

The S&P 500 posted its first gain since setting an all-time high the prior Friday, the Dow was roughly flat and the Nasdaq gained around 0.5%, led by AI-related earnings beats (CoreWeave +~18% on a narrower loss and in-line revenue). Sets a broadly constructive tone into the European open, tempered by the Middle East oil-supply risk above. US July PPI and weekly jobless claims are due 13:30 BST today — a live catalyst later in the session.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

CONTRACT	LEVEL	IMPLIED MOVE	COLLECTION TIME
Euro Stoxx 50 futures (FESX)	~6,566-6,591 range, last ~6,572 (indicative only, no clean timestamp)	Broadly firmer indicated	05:50-07:15 BST
DAX futures (FDAX)	n/a — no confirmed 13 Aug pre-open print	n/a	05:50-07:15 BST
CAC 40 futures (FCE)	n/a — not found via open sources	n/a	05:50-07:15 BST
FTSE 100 futures (Z)	n/a for today — only a stale 12 Aug morning print (~10,825-10,827) was found; not used	n/a	05:50-07:15 BST
Broad regional indication			
STOXX Europe 600 futures	n/a precise level	~+0.26% to +0.28% (single-source snapshot, low confidence)	05:50-07:15 BST
US context — futures pre-market			
S&P 500 e-mini	n/a precise level	Little changed / marginally lower ahead of PPI	05:50-07:15 BST
Nasdaq 100 e-mini	n/a precise level	~-0.1%, pressured by Cisco's post-earnings reaction	05:50-07:15 BST

European futures are indicated modestly firmer on the AI/chip rally carrying over from Asia and Wall Street's near-record close, but precise point levels for DAX, CAC and FTSE futures this morning could not be reliably confirmed via open web access — treat the directional read as the useful signal, not the exact numbers. US futures are little changed to marginally softer, with Cisco's after-hours sell-off despite a beat weighing on Nasdaq futures. Expect a headline-sensitive open around the ongoing Middle East shipping disruption and this morning's UK GDP release.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (WEDNESDAY 12 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	~6,559	+0.08%
DAX 40	~26,331	−0.17% to −0.23% (two sources differ slightly)
CAC 40	n/a exact level (two mirrors confirm the % move)	−0.46%
FTSE 100	10,821-10,833 (three sources disagree on exact print)	−0.1% to −0.22%

European markets were subdued Wednesday, holding near recent record highs but drifting slightly lower into the US CPI print, as a strong Q2 earnings season (LSEG estimates ~22% y/y European earnings growth) was weighed against Strait of Hormuz-related energy-supply risk. Energy and tech had led Tuesday's session; Wednesday's tone was softer, with accelerating German inflation cited as one drag. Exact closing levels for the CAC 40 and FTSE 100 carry source disagreement — direction (lower) is the consistent read across sources.

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (WEDNESDAY 12 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,748.50	+0.26% to +0.3%	First gain since Friday 7 Aug's all-time high
Dow Jones Industrial Average	~53,770	−0.04% (~−21 pts)	Essentially flat
Nasdaq Composite	26,588.49	+0.54%	AI-earnings led

A constructive but not euphoric session — the S&P notched its first gain since last Friday's record high, driven by cooler-than-feared July CPI and strong AI-related earnings, while the Dow was essentially flat. **Leading names:** AI and technology, with CoreWeave jumping roughly 18% after narrowing its loss per share on in-line revenue. **Notable mover:** Cisco closed the regular session at \$123.88 but sold off after-hours despite beating estimates and raising guidance, as its ~\$9bn AI order-backlog commentary failed to satisfy the market. Lagging-sector detail for the session could not be confirmed via open sources and is not itemized rather than guessed.

Key takeaway: Cooler CPI reduced near-term Fed urgency, but futures still price a meaningful ~40-50% chance of a September hike under new Chair Kevin Warsh — an unusual hiking-bias regime worth flagging for European rate-sensitive sectors today.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION (THURSDAY 13 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	~68,490-68,610 (sources vary)	+1.1% to +1.82% — fresh record/multi-year highs, tech-led
Hang Seng	~25,453	+0.1% to +0.18%
Shanghai Composite	n/a for 13 Aug; last confirmed close 12 Aug 3,946.68	12 Aug: +0.32%; today's print not confirmed
Kospi (South Korea)	~6,835	+3.9% to +4.8% (sources vary) — Samsung/SK Hynix surge on Temasek investment reports

Broadly risk-on across Asia, led by a continuing AI/semiconductor rally out of Wall Street plus fresh, Korea-specific fuel from reports that Temasek plans direct stakes in Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix — the Kospi's biggest regional gain, pushing it toward bull-market territory. Japan's Topix also reportedly hit a fresh record on the same soft-CPI, AI-led tailwind. Hong Kong lagged the region's gains noticeably; mainland China's same-day close could not be confirmed. Direct positive read-through for European chip-equipment names (ASML, ASM International, BEI) at today's open.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	TIME
Brent (ICE, USD/bbl)	~\$87.9-89.0	Wed close ~\$88.98 (+~2% on the Red Sea/Gulf of Oman attacks); Thu morning indicated ~\$87.92, -1.2% pullback	Wed 12 - Thu 13 Aug
WTI (NYMEX, USD/bbl)	~\$82.1-83.3	Wed settle ~\$83.27; Thu morning indicated ~\$82.11, -1.4% pullback	Wed 12 - Thu 13 Aug
Gold (XAU/USD, USD/oz)	~\$4,399-4,409	+0.66% d/d (Wed close \$4,399.22); +~31% y/y	Wed 12 Aug
Natural gas (Henry Hub, USD/MMBtu)	n/a confirmed spot; EIA 3Q26 forecast avg ~\$2.87	Futures through Sept 2026 forecast below \$3.00	Forecast, not a dated spot print
Natural gas (European TTF, EUR/MWh)	<€59	Fell below €59 on 12 Aug on eased supply-diversification signals	Wed 12 Aug
Copper (COMEX, USD/lb / LME, USD/tonne)	~\$6.57/lb Thu, off a record ~\$6.71-6.81/lb (LME ~\$14,455/tonne record) set 12 Aug	Easing from Wednesday's fresh record; still +~9% on the month	Wed 12 - Thu 13 Aug

Oil jumped roughly 2% Wednesday on the Red Sea fatality and the Gulf of Oman incident before easing back this morning — the Strait of Hormuz disruption remains the dominant swing factor and reversal risk stays high in either direction through the session. Gold continues to hold a firm bid near \$4,400/oz, up roughly 31% year-on-year, as Fed hike-versus-hold uncertainty and Middle East risk both support bullion. Copper set a fresh Comex/LME record on 12 August on a London physical squeeze and Chile mine-output downgrades, plus continued AI-data-centre demand, before easing slightly into Thursday — still a notable tailwind for miners' realized prices. European TTF gas eased below €59/MWh despite the shipping disruption, suggesting supply diversification is currently outweighing Mideast-linked LNG risk, though this should be watched for reversal.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	TIME
US Treasury 10-year	~4.68%	Little changed after in-line July CPI; down from >4.71% Monday	Tue 11 – Wed 12 Aug
German Bund 10-year	~3.10-3.15% (low confidence, no single dated primary source)	Range-bound through August	Wed 12 Aug
EUR/USD	~1.1543 (weekly range 1.1500-1.1580)	Consolidating near two-month highs	Tue 11 Aug close
GBP/USD	1.3507	–0.01% d/d; near highest since 16 Jul	Wed 12 Aug
DXY (Dollar Index)	~99.84, edging toward 99.9	Modest gains ahead of the CPI print	Wed 12 Aug

None of the figures above could be confirmed as a genuine real-time Thursday pre-08:00 BST print — all are the latest confirmed Tuesday/Wednesday levels and should be re-checked against a live terminal. Treasury yields are little changed post-CPI, consistent with the market still debating a September Fed hike rather than pricing a clean easing path — an unusual regime worth flagging for rate-sensitive European sectors. The dollar index sits little changed near recent levels; EUR/USD is consolidating near two-month highs and GBP/USD holds near its best level since mid-July, both ahead of this morning's UK GDP release.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (WEDNESDAY 12 AUGUST 2026)

ISSUER	CURRENCY	SIZE	MATURITY	COUPON/SPREAD	NOTES
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No EUR-denominated institutional corporate IG, HY, SSA or FIG benchmark deal could be confirmed as pricing on Wednesday 12 August 2026 — consistent with the seasonal August lull (see commentary). The only dated 12 Aug data point found was the German Mittelstand SME bond segment (a distinct retail/mid-cap market, not institutional benchmark): 16 issues placed, €369.8m total volume, average coupon 7.52%, 7 of 16 in renewables. n/a for institutional benchmark deals — not fabricated.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY & THIS WEEK

GlobalCapital headlines (search-snippet access only, direct fetch blocked) describe a month-long SSA supply drought about to end, with issuers reportedly mandating "ahead of next week's big-name SSA restart." A second snippet suggested some supply the week following 12 August before a "proper reopening" from around 24 August — the two snippets give slightly different restart dates (~17 Aug vs ~24 Aug) that could not be reconciled against the primary source. No specific corporate IG/HY mandate or rumoured name could be confirmed for today or the rest of this week.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	MOVE / DIRECTION	AS OF
iTraxx Europe Main 5yr	~50-51bp (STALE — early July reference)	Not day-of; indicative/historical only	Early Jul 2026
iTraxx Europe Crossover 5yr	~315-320bp (STALE — mid-May reference)	Not day-of; indicative/historical only	Mid-May 2026
CDX IG 5yr (USD)	~81bp (single source, not cross-referenced)	Low confidence	Early Aug 2026
Avg euro corporate IG spread (OAS)	n/a — not found	—	—
Euro HY OAS (ICE BofA, context)	n/a — series exists through 30 Jul 2026 on FRED but no bp figure extractable	—	—

None of the spread figures above could be confirmed as current for the 12-13 August window; none were cross-checked across two independent same-week sources. Treat as last-known reference points only — a live terminal check is required before use.

COMMENTARY

Euro primary remains in its expected mid-August seasonal lull — no confirmed institutional-benchmark EUR deal priced yesterday, and trade-press coverage consistently frames August as a quiet stretch ahead of a broader reopening. Multiple sources agree the SSA segment specifically has gone through a "dead quiet" multi-week stretch, now expected to reopen "extremely busy" from roughly the week of 17-24 August (exact date unreconciled between two GlobalCapital snippets). Broader 2026 supply context: summer volumes are tracking roughly 5% above the prior seasonal record (€307bn in summer 2025), with Q3 2026 net supply projected up ~5% to just under €110bn, around half of that concentrated in September. No day-of sector skew toward industrials, transport or energy could be established given the lack of confirmed prints. Recommend a live IFR/GlobalCapital/Bloomberg spread check before use in a trading context.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR (TODAY, 13 AUGUST 2026)

TIME (BST)	REGION	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
07:00	UK	GDP monthly estimate (June) & Q2 2026 first estimate, plus Industrial/Manufacturing Production and Trade Balance (bundled ONS release)	No consensus figure confirmed	HIGH
07:00	UK	Business Investment, Q2 2026 (provisional)	No consensus figure confirmed	MEDIUM
~10:00-11:00 (approximate)	Eurozone	Industrial Production (June)	No consensus figure confirmed	MEDIUM
13:30	US	Producer Price Index (July)	No consensus figure confirmed	HIGH
13:30	US	Weekly Initial Jobless Claims (week ended 8 Aug)	Prior 199K — third straight sub-200K week, longest streak since 1969	MEDIUM-HIGH
13:30	US	Continuing Jobless Claims (week ended 1 Aug)	No consensus figure confirmed	MEDIUM

No ECB, BoE or Fed policy decision falls today — the ECB held at 2.25% on 23 July (next decision 10 September, flagged by Chief Economist Lane as pivotal for a possible hike), the BoE held Bank Rate at 3.75% on 30 July (6-3 vote, three members favouring a hike; next decision 17 September), and the Fed held at 3.50-3.75% on 29-30 July under new Chair Kevin Warsh (9-3 vote, three dissents favouring a hike; next FOMC 15-16 September). Today's UK GDP/Q2 bundle is the highest-profile European release, with US PPI and jobless claims the key US prints ahead of a still-live September Fed hike debate.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

COMPANY	MARKET	EVENT	TIME
Secure Trust Bank (LSE: STB)	Europe/ UK	H1 2026 interim results	Time n/a
London Stock Exchange Group (LSE: LSEG)	Europe/ UK	Ex-dividend date for interim dividend, 55.0p (+17% y/y)	Today
Cisco Systems (NASDAQ: CSCO)	US	Reported fiscal Q4/FY2026 results after Wednesday's close — beat on EPS/ revenue, raised FY27 guidance, but shares fell after-hours	Reported after Wed 12 Aug close
Applied Materials (NASDAQ: AMAT)	US	Fiscal Q3 2026 results — key AI/semis-capex read ahead of Friday's European open	After US close today

Today's confirmed European corporate slate is thin — Secure Trust Bank's H1 results and LSEG's ex-dividend date are the two confirmed items; a fuller FTSE/ European large-cap earnings list could not be verified via open search this morning (paywalled/JS-gated calendars) and is not itemized rather than guessed — check Investegate/LSE RNS at the open for confirmation. In the US, Applied Materials reports after the close today, offering a fresh AI-capex read after Cisco's mixed beat-and-sell-off reaction overnight. Aggregator estimates suggest a heavy US reporting day overall (~250-290 companies) but only the most market-relevant names are itemized above.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Frontline / DHT Holdings & tanker owners — Shipping	Strait of Hormuz effectively closed to normal commercial traffic; naval-escorted convoys only (~8 ships/day vs ~73/day normal). Tanker charter rates have surged roughly 20-fold toward \$500,000/day on some routes; war-risk insurance up to 3-10% of hull value from ~0.25% pre-war.	Bullish / event-risk
BP (LSE: BP) / Shell (LSE: SHEL) — Energy	Both posted strong Q2 results with raised buybacks/dividends and led recent FTSE 100 gains as Brent traded near \$88-90/bbl on Middle East supply risk.	Bullish momentum
IAG (LSE: IAG) / easyJet (LSE: EZJ) / Ryanair / Lufthansa (ETR: LHA) — Aviation	Airlines continue pulling Middle East capacity (Europe-Middle East seats down ~11% for 2026); jet fuel costs up sharply on the Hormuz disruption. IATA warns industry profitability is running roughly half of prior expectations this year on fuel and disruption costs.	Bearish / event-risk
BAE Systems (LSE: BA.) / Rolls-Royce (LSE: RR.) — Aerospace & Defense	Among Wednesday's FTSE 100 gainers, benefiting from a continued geopolitical-tension premium as the Middle East conflict and Russia-Ukraine exchanges persist.	Bullish
Rheinmetall (ETR: RHM) — Aerospace & Defense	Still recovering reputationally after an 18% one-day slump in late June on reports Germany was scrapping warship plans; full-year sales guidance (+40-45%) remains intact.	Event-risk / mixed
Glencore (LSE: GLEN) / Antofagasta (LSE: ANTO) — Metals & Mining	Comex/LME copper hit a fresh record (~\$6.71-6.81/lb; LME ~\$14,455/tonne) on 12 Aug on a London physical squeeze, Chile mine-output downgrades and continued AI-data-centre demand, before easing slightly Thursday. Indonesia's Grasberg-linked Gresik smelter remains down after an 8 Aug boiler leak — a flag for volume guidance even as prices support realized margins.	Bullish on price, mixed on supply
Balfour Beatty (LSE: BBY) — Construction	Hit a record high after raising its annual forecast, noted among Wednesday's FTSE gainers.	Bullish
CMC Markets (LSE: CMCX) — Financials	FTSE 250's top gainer year-to-date in 2026 on elevated trading volumes amid volatile, headline-driven markets.	Bullish / momentum
Applied Materials (NASDAQ: AMAT) — Semiconductors	Reports fiscal Q3 results after today's US close — a key AI-capex read that will shape European semis sentiment (ASML, ASMI, BESI) into Friday's open.	Event-risk

**Samsung Electronics /
SK Hynix — read-
through: ASML, ASM
International, BE
Semiconductor**

Kospi jumped ~4-5% overnight on reports Temasek plans direct stakes in both Korean chipmakers, extending the AI/memory rally. Positive read-through for European chip-equipment names at today's open.

Bullish

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

US CPI in-line, hike debate persists: July CPI cooled to 3.4% y/y (core 2.5%), matching estimates, but doesn't resolve the unusual hiking-bias cycle under new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh — the July FOMC vote was 9-3 to hold, with three dissents favouring a hike. September hike odds sit roughly 40-50% post-CPI.

BoE and ECB both on hold, flagged as hawkish-leaning: the BoE held Bank Rate at 3.75% on 30 July (6-3, three wanted a hike; UK CPI 2.6% in June, inflation seen peaking near 3.2% in Q4); the ECB held its deposit rate at 2.25% on 23 July, with Chief Economist Philip Lane flagging 10 September as the pivotal meeting for a possible hike given energy-shock inflation risk.

Commodities: Comex/LME copper set a fresh record on 12 August on a London supply squeeze and AI-data-centre demand; gold holds a firm bid above \$4,300-4,400/oz on the same hike/hold uncertainty plus Middle East risk.

CORPORATE

M&A: Clean Harbors agreed to acquire EnviroServe from One Rock Capital Partners for \$470m cash; RTW Biotech's Avere Therapeutics agreed to merge with NextCure in an all-stock deal expected to close by year-end; a Blackstone-led group invested in Air Canada's Aeroplan loyalty programme (all announced 12 Aug).

Earnings: Cisco beat estimates and raised FY27 guidance but shares fell after-hours; BP and Shell both posted strong Q2 results with raised buybacks/dividends amid the oil-price rally.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Middle East: the Strait of Hormuz is effectively closed to normal commercial shipping, with naval-escorted convoys the only traffic. Houthi rebels killed six in an attack on a Red Sea cargo ship (the first Red Sea shipping fatalities in over a year), and US forces fired on a vessel allegedly breaching the US blockade of Iranian ports in the Gulf of Oman. This remains the dominant driver for oil, shipping, aviation and inflation expectations.

Russia-Ukraine: continued drone/missile exchanges reported 12 Aug — Ukrainian strikes on Russian Black Sea Fleet assets near Novorossiysk/Sevastopol/Crimea, Russian drone strikes on Odesa, Zaporizhzhia and Kherson. President Zelensky said Russia "will stop" the war citing an unspecified plan — no imminent ceasefire confirmed.

US tariffs: Trump paused a threatened increase of the reciprocal tariff to 125% for a further 90 days (11 Aug); a 35% tariff on Canada took effect 1 August; a 15% tariff plus price floors on polysilicon imports was ordered 6 August; pharma tariffs are reportedly under discussion toward 200% later in 2026.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. Strait of Hormuz disruption and oil-price swing risk

The dominant driver for oil, shipping and aviation; Brent easing this morning but reversal risk stays high in either direction.

2. UK GDP/Q2 first estimate, 07:00 BST

The day's highest-profile European data point, bundled with industrial production and trade balance.

3. US PPI and jobless claims, 13:30 BST

Claims have stayed below 200K for a third straight week, the longest such streak since 1969 — a labour-market signal feeding the Fed hike debate.

4. Asian AI/chip rally carrying into Europe

Kospi and Nikkei surged overnight on Temasek/Samsung/SK Hynix reports — direct read-through for ASML, ASMI, BESI.

5. Applied Materials earnings after tonight's US close

A fresh AI-capex read after Cisco's mixed beat-and-sell-off reaction; will shape Friday's European semis open.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. September Fed hike-odds recalibration

An unusual hiking-bias cycle under new Chair Kevin Warsh keeps odds near 40-50% even after in-line CPI.

2. Middle East conflict trajectory

Hormuz shipping restrictions, Red Sea attacks and surging tanker/insurance costs remain the week's dominant tail risk.

3. European DCM primary reopening signals

SSA and corporate issuance expected to restart from roughly 17-24 August after a month-long lull.

4. UK data wave

Today's GDP/Q2 bundle is followed by UK labour-market data on 18 August.

5. Tech-earnings reaction bleed-through

Cisco's "sell the news" reaction and Applied Materials' results will keep shaping global tech sentiment through the week.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Jackson Hole Economic Policy Symposium, 27-29 August

Kansas City Fed's annual gathering, especially significant given the active hike-versus-hold debate this cycle.

2. Strait of Hormuz / Iran conflict trajectory

Remains the dominant macro tail risk for oil, shipping and aviation through the month.

3. UK labour market data, 18 August

Next major UK data point after today's GDP release.

4. Walmart Q2 FY2027 earnings, 20 August

US retail bellwether, a read on consumer resilience amid tariff and inflation pressure.

5. Next FOMC (15-16 Sept), ECB (10 Sept) and BoE (17 Sept) decisions

All three central banks face a live hike debate this cycle; positioning builds through the rest of August, including a concentrated wave of September euro DCM supply (~€110bn Q3 net, roughly half in September).

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Hormuz/oil headline risk: whether the Red Sea/Gulf of Oman incidents escalate further or de-escalate through the session.

UK GDP reaction at 07:00 BST and any follow-through in gilts and GBP.

US PPI/jobless claims at 13:30 BST, feeding the September Fed hike debate.

Asian AI-rally follow-through in European semiconductor names at the open.

1 WEEK

Today: Applied Materials results after the US close, a fresh AI-capex signal.

Ongoing: Middle East conflict trajectory and its knock-on effect on oil, tanker rates and jet fuel costs.

Ongoing: September Fed/ECB/BoE hike-odds recalibration as fresh data arrives; euro DCM primary reopening signals from mid-to-late August.

1 MONTH

18 August: UK labour market data.

20 August: Walmart Q2 FY2027 earnings, a US consumer-resilience read.

27-29 August: Jackson Hole Economic Symposium, closely watched given the active hike/hold debate.

10, 15-16 and 17 September: ECB, FOMC and BoE decisions respectively — all three central banks face a live hike question this cycle.

Ongoing: Strait of Hormuz/Iran conflict remains the dominant tail risk through the month; September euro DCM supply wave (~€110bn Q3 net) builds through late August.

SOURCES

- Al Jazeera / CNBC — Strait of Hormuz, Red Sea and Gulf of Oman shipping attacks
- BLS — July CPI release; PPI/jobless claims schedule
- Bloomberg / Forbes / CNN Business — Fed hike-odds debate, Chair Kevin Warsh, FOMC vote
- AP wire (via multiple mirrors) — US index closes, Asian markets overnight session
- Bloomberg / Yahoo Finance / Korea JoongAng Daily — Kospi, Samsung/SK Hynix, Temasek reports
- Cisco investor relations / Investing.com — Cisco Q4/FY2026 earnings
- Trading Economics / Investing.com / MarketScreener — European index closes and futures (search-snippet access; several figures cross-source inconsistent, flagged inline)
- Forbes Advisor / Fortune / CNBC — gold, oil pricing context
- Mining.com — Comex/LME copper record, Grasberg/Gresik smelter outage
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- GlobalCapital / IFR (search-snippet access only, direct fetch blocked) — DCM primary market colour and credit spreads
- webdisclosure.com / Iron AG — German Mittelstand SME bond issuance, 12 Aug
- ONS release calendar — UK GDP/Q2 bundle, business investment
- Eurostat — Eurozone industrial production schedule
- Investegate — Secure Trust Bank interim results; LSEG investor relations — ex-dividend date
- TipRanks / Zacks — Applied Materials earnings date
- Sunday Guardian Live / Invezz — FTSE 100 gainers, BP/Shell
- WANA / Al Jazeera — tanker charter rates and shipping-insurance premiums
- Proactive Investors — airline Middle East capacity cuts
- CNBC — Rheinmetall context
- Russia Matters war report card, 12 Aug — Russia-Ukraine developments
- Reuters / CalChamber — US tariff developments
- Bank of England / European Central Bank / Federal Reserve — policy meeting dates and votes
- Kansas City Fed — Jackson Hole Economic Symposium dates

Data collected automatically between approximately 05:50 and 07:20 BST on 13 August 2026 via open web search. Direct WebFetch access to several primary sources (GlobalCapital, IFR, TradingEconomics, some Bloomberg pages) was blocked throughout this session; figures from those sources come from search-engine snippet summaries rather than direct page reads. A significant number of figures are marked n/a, given as source ranges, or explicitly flagged as cross-source inconsistent — this applies in particular to DAX/CAC/FTSE futures levels, the exact FTSE and CAC cash closes, Thursday-morning rates/FX prints, same-day DCM spread levels, and Shanghai Composite/CSI 300 levels for the correct session. Verify all figures against a live terminal before making any decision. This document is not investment advice.